

How to be an achiever

There is a story of an artist who painted wonderful pictures. A friend asked him, 'What is the secret of your wonderful art?' The artist showed him a picture and requested his friend to read the words written **beneath** the picture. The words read: 'Master! May this picture **draw** many **unto thee**, but may my name be forgotten!'

Whatever we do, let us do it **in the spirit of** surrender to the Lord! **Any service** to society done with the objective of earning name or fame **is** a **cause** for attachment. One attachment **leads to** another attachment. **Selfless service**, on the other hand, **is** truly **altruistic**. This is what is required, and such aspirations and such actions are **born out of** **humility** that comes with the **exploration** of one's inner Self.



Epictetus was a **slave** in Nero's Rome. **Lame** and poor, he was **nevertheless** content, and his words are respected and **admired** along with the writings of great philosophers of the ancient world. 'If a man is unhappy,' Epictetus wrote, 'remember that his **unhappiness** is his own fault; for God had made all men to be happy.'

J B Priestley expresses this truth, 'To me, there is in happiness, an element of **self-forgetfulness**. You lose yourself in something outside yourself when you are happy; just as when you are **desperately miserable**, you are **intensely conscious of** yourself, and like a solid little **lump** of **ego weighing a tonne**.'

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

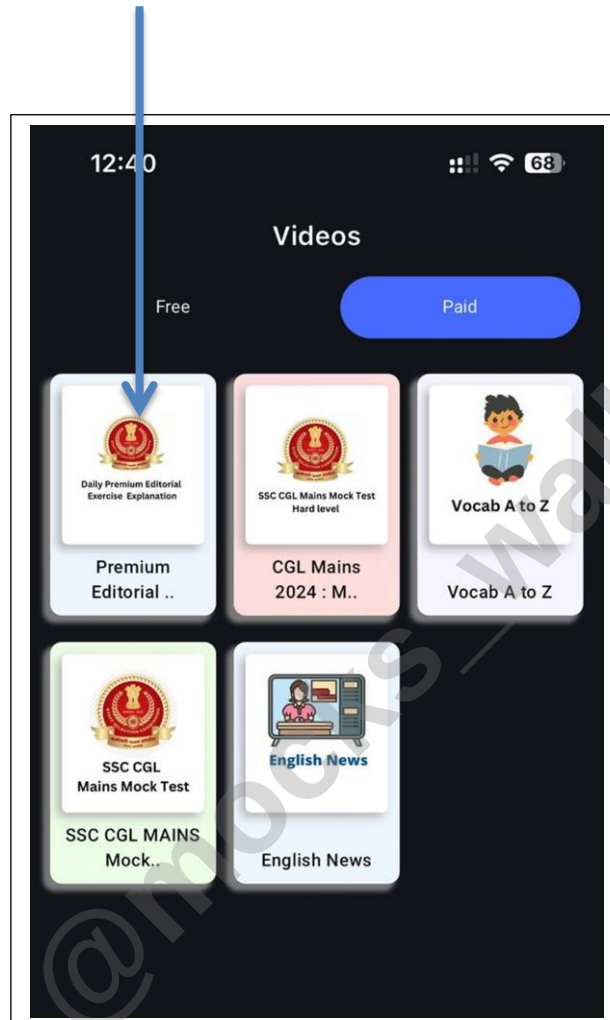
1. **Beneath** (preposition) – under, below, underneath, lower than, at the foot of के नीचे
2. **Draw unto** (phrasal verb) – attract, pull towards, lead to, bring near, invite अपनी ओर खींचना
3. **Thee** (pronoun) – you (archaic form), yourself, thou, thyself, ye आपको
4. **In the spirit of** (phrase) – with the intention of, in the mindset of, motivated by, in the essence of, with the attitude of की भावना के साथ
5. **Cause** (noun) – reason, source, motive, basis, purpose कारण
6. **Lead (to)** (verb) – result in, bring about, cause, produce, give rise to की ओर ले जाना
7. **Altruistic** (adjective) – selfless, charitable, generous, humanitarian, philanthropic परोपकारी
8. **Bear out** (phrasal verb) – confirm, support, validate, uphold, prove पुष्टि करना
9. **Humility** (noun) – modesty, meekness, humbleness, submissiveness, unpretentiousness विनम्रता
10. **Exploration** (noun) – investigation, examination, study, analysis, search खोज
11. **Slave** (noun) – servant, bondman, captive, thrall, serf गुलाम
12. **Lame** (adjective) – crippled, disabled, limping, impaired, weak कमजोर
13. **Nevertheless** (preposition/adverb) – however, yet, still, even so, nonetheless फिर भी
14. **Admire** (verb) – appreciate, respect, praise, value, honour प्रशंसा करना
15. **Unhappiness** (noun) – sorrow, misery, sadness, grief, depression दुःख
16. **Self-forgetfulness** (noun) – selflessness, absorption, loss of ego, detachment, humility आत्म-विस्मृति
17. **Desperately** (adverb) – hopelessly, urgently, intensely, frantically, anxiously निराशापूर्वक
18. **Miserable** (adjective) – unhappy, sorrowful, wretched, dejected, dismal दुखी
19. **Intensely** (adverb) – deeply, strongly, extremely, severely, passionately तीव्रता से
20. **Conscious** (of) (adjective) – aware, mindful, alert, attentive, sentient सजग
21. **Lump** (noun) – chunk, clump, mass, block, piece टुकड़ा
22. **Ego** (noun) – self, self-esteem, pride, self-importance, identity घमंड

23. **Weigh a tonne** (phrase) – feel extremely heavy, burdensome, overwhelming, press

down, weigh heavily बोझिल होना

@mocks_wallah

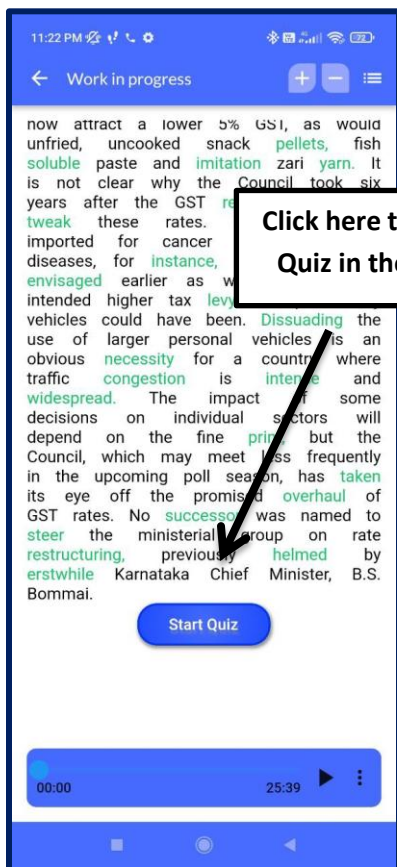
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



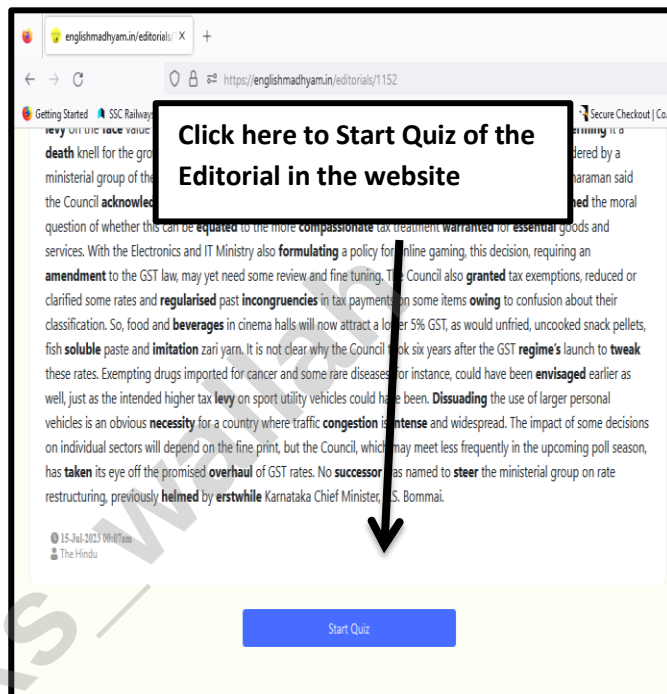
Summary of the Editorial

1. The editorial opens with a story of a humble artist who wished that his name be forgotten while his work brings people closer to the divine.
2. The story emphasizes humility and surrender as essential qualities in any form of true achievement.
3. The artist's message highlights the importance of dedicating one's work to a higher cause rather than personal recognition.
4. The central idea is to perform actions in a spirit of **self-surrender to the Lord**, without attachment to results.
5. Seeking fame or recognition in service leads to attachment, which in turn causes more desires and bondage.
6. True service should be selfless and altruistic, free from personal motives.
7. Such selfless action arises from humility and an inner connection with the Self.
8. Humility is portrayed as a foundation of genuine aspiration and noble deeds.
9. The editorial introduces Epictetus, a lame and poor slave in ancient Rome, who was content and wise.
10. Epictetus's teachings are valued alongside those of great philosophers, showing that greatness lies in attitude, not status.
11. One of Epictetus's core ideas is that unhappiness stems from within and not from external conditions.
12. He suggests that happiness is a natural state, and blaming others or circumstances is a sign of inner weakness.
13. The editorial supports the notion that **true happiness involves self-forgetfulness** and absorption in something beyond oneself.
14. J.B. Priestley is quoted to reinforce the idea that happiness arises when one transcends the ego.
15. The overall message of the editorial is that **true achievement comes from selflessness, humility, and inner contentment**, not external accolades or ego-based pursuits.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



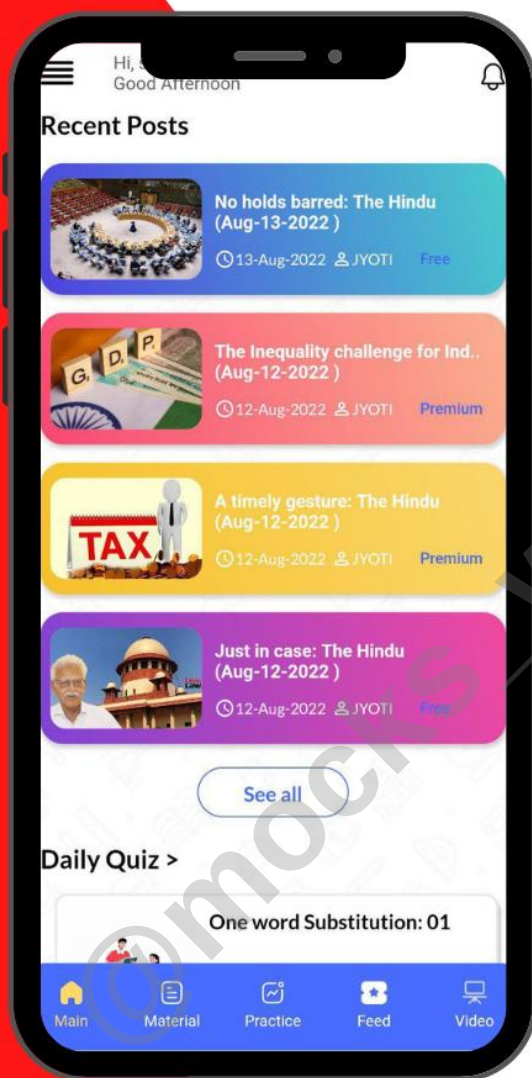
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